Ardwick Logistics — Staff Operations Manual

Section A — Joining the Company

New starter registration. Every new employee completes registration with the people team before their first shift. Registration requires proof of right to work, a bank mandate and an emergency contact. Site access badges. Access badges are issued by reception on the first morning and must be worn visibly inside operational areas. A lost badge carries a replacement charge of 15 pounds. Badges deactivate after ninety days of non-use. Vehicle parking. Staff parking is allocated by depot and is not transferable between sites. The Ardwick site holds 240 marked bays, of which 26 are reserved for visitors and 12 for accessible parking. Overnight parking requires written approval from the depot manager. Canteen and refreshments. The canteen operates from 06:00 to 19:00 on weekdays and 07:00 to 14:00 on Saturdays. Hot food service stops thirty minutes before closing. Vending machines in the transport office run continuously. Network accounts. IT accounts are created from the registration record and are usually active within one working day. Initial passwords are issued verbally by the service desk and changed at first sign-in. Accounts dormant for sixty days are suspended pending manager confirmation. Expense account setup. An expense account is opened alongside the network account. Opening the account does not itself authorise any spending, and the authorisation limits are set out later in this manual. The first expense claim made by a new starter is reviewed manually.

Section B — Travel and Subsistence

Booking channel. All business travel is booked through the nominated travel desk. Bookings made outside that channel are reimbursed only where the traveller can show the desk was unavailable and the journey could not be deferred. Rail is the default mode for domestic journeys under four hours. Subsistence allowance. The daily subsistence allowance is 38 pounds for domestic travel and 61 pounds for international travel. It is paid for each full day away and halved for a day of departure or return. Private mileage. Where a private vehicle is used for a business journey the mileage reimbursement rate is 45 pence per mile for the first ten thousand miles in a year and 25 pence per mile thereafter. A passenger supplement of 5 pence per mile applies for each colleague carried. Journeys between home and the normal place of work are not reimbursable. Accommodation ceilings. Hotel spend is capped at 140 pounds per night in London and 95 pounds per night elsewhere in the United Kingdom. Rates above the ceiling require prior written approval. Travel documentation. Employees travelling internationally hold a valid passport with at least six months remaining. The company meets the cost of business visas but not of passport renewal. Travel insurance. Corporate travel insurance covers booked business travel automatically. Cover does not extend to leisure days added either side of a trip unless declared to the travel desk in advance.

Section C — Equipment and Systems

Standard issue. Office-based staff are issued a laptop and a docking station. Operational staff are issued a handheld terminal. Equipment remains company property and is returned on the final day of employment. Refresh cycle. Laptops are replaced on a four year cycle and handheld terminals on a three year cycle. Replacement outside the cycle requires a fault report from the service desk. Withdrawn devices are wiped and either resold or recycled through an accredited contractor. Mobile telephones. A company mobile is provided to roles with an on-call obligation. Personal use is permitted within reason. The monthly data allowance is 40 gigabytes, and usage beyond that is recharged to the department rather than to the individual. Software requests. Requests for software outside the standard build go to the service desk and require line manager approval. Licences are assigned to the individual and reclaimed when the individual leaves. Printing. Printing is charged to departmental cost centres at 4 pence per mono page and 19 pence per colour page. Jobs left unclaimed for 24 hours are deleted. Loss and damage. Where company equipment is lost or damaged the employee reports it to the service desk within one working day. The company may recover a contribution towards replacement where the loss resulted from negligence rather than ordinary wear. The contribution is not automatic and depends on the age of the device; the amounts recovered are set out in the following section.

Section D — Recovery Amounts and Working Time

Equipment loss excess. Continuing from the previous section, the contribution recovered for a negligent loss is 120 pounds for a laptop, 75 pounds for a handheld terminal and 45 pounds for a mobile telephone. Nothing is recovered where the device is more than three years old, and nothing is recovered for a first incident in any rolling three year period. Standard hours. Full time hours are 37.5 per week for office roles and 42 per week for operational roles, exclusive of unpaid breaks. The reference period for averaging working time is seventeen weeks. Overtime. Overtime is paid at time and a quarter on weekdays and time and a half on Sundays and public holidays. Overtime is authorised in advance by the depot manager, and unauthorised hours are not paid. Rest breaks. A rest break of thirty minutes applies to any shift exceeding six hours. Drivers are additionally subject to statutory tachograph rules, which take precedence wherever they are more restrictive than this manual. Shift swaps. Swaps between colleagues are permitted where both hold the relevant competence and the swap is recorded in the rota system before the shift begins. Time recording. Hours are recorded through the depot terminal at the start and end of each shift. A missed clocking is corrected by the supervisor and confirmed by the employee within five working days.

Section E — Absence and Leave

Annual leave entitlement. The standard entitlement is 25 days per year plus public holidays, rising to 28 days after five years of continuous service. Entitlement is pro-rated for part time staff and the leave year runs from the first of April. Carry over. A maximum of five days may be carried into the following leave year and must be taken by the thirtieth of June. Carry over beyond five days is granted only where leave was refused for operational reasons. Sickness absence. Absence is reported to the line manager by telephone before the start of the shift. Self certification covers the first seven calendar days and beyond that a fit note is required. Company sick pay is paid at full rate for up to twelve weeks in a rolling year, subject to length of service. Parental leave. Maternity, paternity, adoption and shared parental leave follow statutory entitlement, with an enhanced company element of twelve weeks at full pay for the primary carer after two years of service. Bereavement. Paid bereavement leave of five days is available on the death of an immediate family member and one day for a wider relative. Unpaid sabbatical. A sabbatical of between one and six months may be requested after four years of service. Sabbaticals are unpaid, preserve continuity of service, and are granted at the discretion of the divisional director.

Section F — Performance and Development

Review cycle. Formal performance reviews are held twice a year, in April and October. Each review records objectives, evidence against them and a development plan. Interim conversations are expected monthly but are not recorded centrally. Rating scale. Performance is rated on a four point scale: exceptional, strong, effective and developing. Ratings are moderated across each division before release so that standards are comparable between depots. Promotion. Promotion is considered once a year following the April cycle. A case requires two consecutive ratings of strong or above and a vacancy at the target grade. Acting-up arrangements are capped at nine months. Training budget. The annual training budget is 900 pounds per employee for professional development, held at departmental level. Statutory and safety training is funded separately and does not draw on this budget. Performance improvement. Where performance is rated developing for two consecutive cycles a formal improvement plan of up to twelve weeks is opened. The plan sets measurable outcomes and is reviewed fortnightly. Appeals. An employee may appeal a rating within ten working days of release. Appeals are heard by a manager one level above the reviewer and outside the immediate reporting line.

Section G — Security and Information

Password standards. Passwords are at least fourteen characters and are not rotated on a schedule, in line with current guidance. Reuse of a password across company and personal services is prohibited. Multi-factor authentication. Multi-factor authentication is mandatory for all remote access and for any administrative account. Hardware tokens are issued to roles handling payment data. Data classification. Information is classified as public, internal, confidential or restricted. Restricted material may not be removed from company premises or systems under any circumstances. Confidential material may be taken off site only on encrypted company equipment. Incident reporting. Suspected security incidents are reported to the service desk immediately and in any case within one hour of discovery. Reporting in good faith is never itself a disciplinary matter. Clear desk. Desks are clear of confidential material at the end of each day. Printed confidential material is disposed of in the secure bins provided rather than in general waste. Visitors. Visitors sign in at reception, are issued a temporary badge and are escorted at all times within operational areas. Visitor badges expire at the end of the day of issue.

Section H — Purchasing and Suppliers

Authorisation thresholds. Purchase orders up to 2,500 pounds are authorised by the line manager. Between 2,500 and 25,000 pounds authorisation rests with the divisional director. Above 25,000 pounds board approval is required. Splitting a purchase to stay below a threshold is treated as a disciplinary matter. Supplier onboarding. New suppliers are onboarded by procurement following financial and compliance checks. Onboarding takes fifteen working days on average. No order may be placed with a supplier that has not completed onboarding. Contract terms. Standard payment terms are sixty days from invoice date. Deviation from standard terms requires procurement approval and is recorded against the supplier record. Invoice handling. Invoices are matched against the purchase order and the goods receipt before payment. A mismatch of more than two percent is referred back to the raising department. Disputes. A disputed invoice is placed on hold and escalated to procurement within five working days. Payment of the undisputed portion continues in the meantime. Single supplier risk. Where a category has only one qualified supplier, procurement records the exposure on the risk register and reviews it quarterly. The register is presented to the board twice a year.